B.E.T.Trade

News Trading

Course notes - Lessons 05.1 to 05.4

NFP · CPI · FOMC · trade the reaction, not the spike

WHAT'S INSIDE

Notes generated from the B.E.T.Trade Forex course, built from the author's own trading plan and journal. For the full lessons with video walkthroughs, see the Pro tier.

NEWS TRADING · LESSON 05.1

The releases that move it

Most days price respects your levels - then a red-folder release drops and the market stops being technical for a few minutes. Knowing which events do that, and exactly when, is the first half of news trading.

~6 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

Only a handful of releases actually move forex: **NFP, CPI, FOMC** (plus the Powell presser), **PPI**, and the **ECB / BoE** rate decisions. Know the calendar and the exact NY time - in my notes these are **"manual intervention"**.

Intro - the days the market stops being *technical*

Most days, price respects your levels and your killzones behave. Then a red-folder release drops and the market does whatever it wants for a few minutes. That is not your setup failing - that is **manual intervention**. Knowing which events do this, and exactly when, is the entire first half of news trading.

You do not need to become an economist. You need to know the short list of releases that move your pairs, what time they hit, and that they temporarily suspend the normal game.

The releases that *actually* matter

Forget the full economic calendar. For forex, this short list is what moves the dollar and your majors:

Event	When (NY)	Why it matters
NFP - US jobs	08:30, 1st Friday	Biggest scheduled USD mover of the month
CPI - US inflation	08:30	Drives Fed rate expectations
FOMC rate decision	14:00 (+ presser 14:30)	The Fed itself - whole-market mover
PPI	08:30	Inflation, an early tell before CPI
ECB decision	08:15 (presser 08:45)	Moves EUR pairs
BoE decision	07:00	Moves GBP pairs
PMI / retail sales / Powell speaks	various	Second-tier, but still spike

"Manual intervention" - my *mental model*

From my notes, written in red: the big ones - **FOMC, CPI, NFP** - are manual intervention. The algorithm's normal, orderly delivery pauses and a human-scale shove takes over for a few minutes. Very often that window is simply **untradeable**: trying to trade the print itself is gambling, not trading.

> **A red folder on the calendar = manual intervention. Mark these before the session even starts. Half of news trading is just knowing one is coming.**

Know the time, set an *alarm*

Almost every US number lands at **08:30 NY** - the exception is FOMC at **14:00** (presser 14:30). ECB and BoE land in the London morning. Drop the week's red folders onto your chart on Sunday night and set alarms. The worst losses happen when a release ambushes you in the middle of an open trade.

NEWS TRADING · LESSON 05.2

How price behaves

A release looks random. It is not - it is a liquidity event. Price runs the stops first, whipsaws, and only then commits. Learn the pattern and the spike stops fooling you.

~6 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

News is a **liquidity event**, not a coin flip. Price usually runs the stops first (a fake move / Judas), whipsaws both ways, and only *then* delivers the real move. The spike is the trap, not the signal.

News is a *liquidity event*, not a coin flip

It looks random. It is not. A release is a giant magnet for stops - everyone's protective orders sit in the same obvious places, and the volatility is perfect cover to take them. Price typically runs one side, or both, whipsaws, and only then commits to a direction.

The pre-news *Judas*

Often the move starts **before** the number even prints. In my notes I will see price get pushed into the liquidity just before the release - a Judas to set the trap - then the news drops and the real delivery goes the other way. If you got long into "obvious" highs right before CPI, you were the liquidity.

FROM THE JOURNAL - READING THE SETUP BEFORE PMI

Relative equal lows and unfilled FVGs were stacking up under price, so the read was that the dollar print would come in strong and EUR would fall. Just before the news, price pushed up and took the buyers' stops at the recent equal lows - then it delivered down. The point: you anticipate which side is primed, you do not pre-position into the print.

The spike, the whipsaw, the *spread*

At the release you get a violent candle, often a stop-run in **both** directions, and spreads and slippage blow out - your broker widens, and your stop can fill far past where you placed it. This is exactly why the moment of the print is the most dangerous time to have an order working.

The first candle after the news is a trap dressed as a signal. The clean move usually comes after the whipsaw, not during it.

Powell-speak and "*high resistance*"

A scheduled number is one shove and done. Live commentary - the FOMC presser, Powell speaking - is different: it is a stream of headlines, so price chops in what my notes call **high-resistance** price action, full of fakeouts with no clean delivery. Treat speaker events as choppy until price proves otherwise.

Trading the reaction

You do not beat the news by predicting the number. You beat it by reading what price does after - the same sweep, MSS and FVG you already know, with extra discipline.

~7 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

Never trade the spike - it is gambling. Trade the reaction: let the news sweep liquidity, wait for an **MSS**, enter on the FVG it leaves. **No MSS, no trade.** Size down for the blown-out spread.

Don't trade the news - trade the *reaction*

My single rule, straight from the notes: the print itself is untradeable, so I **sit on my hands** through it. The edge is not predicting the number - it is reading what price does after. It is the same skeleton as a killzone: the news sweeps a pool, you wait for the Market Structure Shift, you enter on the FVG the displacement leaves behind.

The *sequence*

1. Mark your liquidity **before** the news - session highs/lows, equal highs/lows.
2. Let the release **run the stops** - watch, do not touch.
3. Wait for a clean **MSS** on your execution timeframe.
4. Enter on the **FVG / PD array** the displacement leaves.
5. Target the opposing liquidity, and **size down** - the stop is wider than normal.

No MSS, *no trade*

This is where most news losses come from - taking the liquidity grab as the signal without waiting for structure to confirm.

FROM THE JOURNAL - THE NEWS TRADE THAT FAILED

Price took the **News BSL**, then formed a SIBI and I entered there - but there was **no MSS**, and price never traded below the BISI to give a clean -IFVG. Without that structure shift it had no reason to reverse. Result: a full **-1R** on a setup that *looked* like the reaction but was never confirmed. Logged lesson: the sweep is not the entry, the MSS is.

The news liquidity grab is the bait. Your trigger is the MSS that follows - never the grab itself.

Spread, size, and the *10:00 fallback*

Account for the blown-out spread by widening your stop and **halving your size**. And if 08:30 was a muddy two-way mess with no clean MSS, you already know the fallback from the Killzones lessons: wait for the **10:00 Silver Bullet**, which often delivers the clean version of the morning's move once the news dust settles.

Discipline & the prop-firm reality

The highest-value news skill is the one nobody posts about: doing nothing. Here is when to be flat, why holding through a print ends accounts, and why funded firms restrict news.

~6 min read

TL;DR - IF YOU'RE IN A HURRY

The most valuable news skill is **being flat**. FOMC and PPI mornings and stacked-news days are often untradeable - sit them out. And prop firms restrict news trading for good reason (slippage, gaps, gambling); the deep dive is the final chapter.

The best news trade is often *no trade*

Knowing when to do nothing is the whole edge here. From my notes: on a **PPI morning** the right play was to sit on my hands and do nothing; on an **FOMC day**, do not trade at all - close to break-even and step away. The number will move price hundreds of points; your only job is to not be standing in front of it.

"Lots of news = no clean setups"

A day stacked with releases rarely gives clean delivery - it is one whipsaw after another. One of my shortest journal notes says it all: **lots of news, not many good setups**. On those days, lower your expectations or just close the laptop.

FROM THE JOURNAL - THE DISCIPLINE WIN

Mid-session I noticed it was an **FOMC day**, saw that price was not doing what it should, and was not confident in the trade - so I closed it at **break-even** instead of hoping. No loss is a result on a day that is designed to take your money.

Don't hold *naked* through the print

- Be **flat** into the release unless trading the reaction is the actual plan.
- No leaving a runner through FOMC "to see what happens" - that is how gaps and slippage end accounts.
- Gap risk applies to news too: a position open into a surprise can jump straight past your stop.

Why prop firms *restrict* news trading

This is the bridge to the final chapter. Most funded-account firms **ban or heavily restrict** trading around high-impact news - some void trades placed in the seconds around a release, some require you to be flat. The reasons are exactly what this lesson described: slippage past your stop, gaps, requotes, and the simple fact that gambling the print blows challenges. The full rules - FTMO, FundedNext, The5ers and friends - are the next and final chapter of the Forex track.

If a setup only works by gambling the news spike, a prop firm will not let you trade it - and neither should you.

Cheatsheet

Situation	What to do
08:30 US print (NFP / CPI / PPI)	Watch - trade the reaction only after an MSS
FOMC 14:00 + presser	Be flat / sit it out
Powell or other speakers	Expect chop, demand an MSS
Stacked-news day	Lower size or stand down
No MSS after the sweep	No trade
Holding into a print	Don't

Last words

News does not break your system - it tests your discipline. The traders who survive news are not the ones who predict the number; they are the ones who wait, demand structure, and are happy to do nothing. Master that and you have removed the single biggest source of random losses left in your week.

That wraps the core Forex track. The final chapter is **Forex Prop Firms** - FTMO and friends, the rules, the drawdown limits, and how to actually pass a challenge.